TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Give Balanced Feedback on Someone's Plan or Work

Express Opinion | OREO | Mini Talk + Questions

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Give balanced feedback on someone's plan or work: your overall view, one thing that works and one concern with examples, and answer a different view.

WHO You work in a small company in Johor Bahru. Your colleague Kumar is in sales.

SITUATION On Thursday at 10 a.m., Kumar has a 15-minute meeting with a new customer, a hotel in town. He wants to show them everything the company does. Yesterday he showed you his draft slides (see the boxes).

NEED Kumar says, "Be honest. What do you think?" He wants to hear what is good and what worries you. Before Thursday, Mr. Tan asks you about the slides too, and he does not fully agree with you.

GOAL Give your overall opinion, say one thing that works and one concern, each with an example, and answer a different view politely without giving up your opinion.

Kumar's draft

- 25 slides
- One price slide: all three packages, RM300, RM500 and RM800 a month
- Big, clear photos of our work
- Slides 9 and 10: the same photos

The meeting

- Thursday, 10 a.m.
- A new customer: a hotel in town
- 15 minutes

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Kumar asks: “I’ve finished my slides for Thursday. Be honest. What do you think?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

> Overall, I think your slides are good, Kumar, but one thing worries me a little. The best part is the price slide, because it’s very clear. For example, all three packages, RM300, RM500 and RM800 a month, are side by side. I know you want to show everything, but my only concern is the length: 25 slides for 15 minutes. For example, slides 9 and 10 show the same photos. So overall, although it’s a bit long, I think it’s a strong presentation.

O OPINION

R WHAT WORKS

E ONE CONCERN

O OPINION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Ali gives Siti feedback on her plan for a lunchtime exercise class. Put his sentences in order.

- [ ] So overall, although the room is a problem, I still think it’s a great idea.
- [ ] The time works well, because Wednesday at 1 p.m. is quiet. For example, we never have meetings then.
- [ ] I think your exercise class is a great idea, Siti, but I have one small concern.
- [ ] However, the meeting room is small. For example, it has space for eight people, and 15 want to join.

Write the letter: **O** = Opinion · **R** = What works · **E** = One concern · **O** = Opinion again

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

GIVE YOUR OVERALL VIEW

- [ ] Overall, I think …
- [ ] I like it, but …
- [ ] In my opinion, …

SAY WHAT WORKS

- [ ] The best part is …
- [ ] … works well, because …
- [ ] I really like …
- [ ] For example, …

SAY ONE CONCERN

- [ ] My only concern is …
- [ ] I'm a bit worried about …
- [ ] … might be a problem.
- [ ] For example, …

SAY IT AGAIN

- [ ] So overall, …
- [ ] …, but I still think …
- [ ] Although …, I think …

ACKNOWLEDGE AND RESPOND

- [ ] I see your point, but …
- [ ] That's true. However, …
- [ ] I understand, but I still think …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I like the price slide. [but / so / because] It's very easy to read.

2. The price slide is clear. [so / because / but] There are too many slides.

3. Kumar's meeting is only 15 minutes. [so / for example, / because] He needs fewer slides.

4. The photos look great. [Although … / So … / Because …] Two slides show the same ones.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. I _____ the price slide a lot. (An opinion about now)
   - ○ like
   - ○ am like
   - ○ liking
2. Slides 9 and 10 _____ the same photos. (A fact about the draft)
   - ○ shows
   - ○ showing
   - ○ show
3. A long talk _____ be boring for the customer. (Something possible, not certain)
   - ○ might
   - ○ might to
   - ○ mights
4. Although the draft _____ long, the photos are great. (A fact inside an although sentence)
   - ○ is
   - ○ be
   - ○ being

SLIDE 09 but · although · however · might

Put a good point and a concern together. But is always fine. Although and however do the same job. Might makes a concern softer.

The price slide is clear, **but** there are too many slides.

Although it's a bit long, it's a strong presentation.

The photos look great. **However**, two slides show the same ones.

The length **might** be a problem for the customer.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O OPINION

Overall, I think …, but …

R WHAT WORKS

The best part is …, because … For example, …

E ONE CONCERN

My only concern is … For example, …

O OPINION AGAIN

So overall, although …, I think …

SLIDE 11

Mini Talk + Questions

Give the owner of a plan your feedback: overall view, one thing that works, one concern, each with an example. The owner fills the feedback note, then asks or disagrees. You answer.

1. Two quiet minutes: on your card, circle one thing that works and one concern. Find an example for each.
2. Round 1 (3:00 each): say your card number. The owner asks 'What do you think?' Feedback: O → R → E → O.
3. Owner: fill the note. Line empty? Ask 'Can you give an example?' Disagree a little. Speaker: acknowledge, answer. Swap.
4. Line B moves. Round 2 (2:00 each): same card, shorter. Move again. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed: feedback only.

Card 1 · A friend's breakfast stall

Card 2 · Siti's email about the annual dinner

Card 3 · Mei Ling's new claim form

Card 4 · A cousin's family trip to Melaka

Feedback note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card no. · overall view			
What works + example			
Concern + example			
Acknowledged? Answered?			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. Kumar worked hard on those 25 slides. Is it fair to say they're too many?
2. The hotel is a big customer. Don't they want to see all our work?
3. Some customers want more detail. Is one price slide really enough?

Start with: **I see your point, but … · That's true. However, … · I understand, but I still think …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Your neighbour shows you her plan for her son's birthday party in the condo function room on Sunday, 3 to 5 p.m.: 30 children, a magician, and food from four different stalls. The room has chairs for 20. Give her balanced feedback.

Overall, I think …, but … · The best part is … · My only concern is … · So overall, …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Gives an overall opinion at the start and again at the end.
- [ ] Names one thing that works and one concern, each with an example.
- [ ] Acknowledges a different view, then answers it and keeps the opinion.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Overall opinion	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
What works + one concern	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Answering another view	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · A friend's breakfast stall

You are the friend with the plan. Ask: 'Be honest. What do you think of my plan?' Fill in the feedback note. Then disagree a little: 'But my food is really good!' or a reason of your own.

Card 2 · Siti's email about the annual dinner

You are Siti. You wrote the email. Ask: 'Can you read my email? What do you think?' Fill in the feedback note. Then disagree a little: 'But people need all the details.' or a reason of your own.

Card 3 · Mei Ling's new claim form

You are Mei Ling. You made the new form. Ask: 'What do you think of my new form?' Fill in the feedback note. Then disagree a little: 'But the old form was much worse.' or a reason of your own.

Card 4 · A cousin's family trip to Melaka

You are the cousin who planned the trip. Ask: 'So, what do you think of my plan?' Fill in the feedback note. Then disagree a little: 'But we only go once a year!' or a reason of your own.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · A friend's breakfast stall

Your friend plans a nasi lemak stall outside a factory. RM7 a plate; the coffee shop across the road sells it for RM5. 300 workers start at 8 a.m. Cash only, no e-wallet. Open 6.30 to 10 a.m. Rent RM600 a month.

Card 2 · Siti's email about the annual dinner

Siti's draft dinner email to all staff: 600 words, three screens on a phone. Day and place are in the first line: Saturday, 7.30 p.m., a restaurant in town. A map link. The reply date, this Friday, is only in the last line.

Card 3 · Mei Ling's new claim form

Mei Ling's new expense claim form: one page, not three. It only opens on a laptop, not on a phone. Sales staff are often out. You add a photo of each receipt. It takes about 5 minutes. Claims still go in by the 25th.

Card 4 · A cousin's family trip to Melaka

Your cousin's plan for Saturday: 8 places to visit in one day. 12 people in 3 cars. Leave JB at 6 a.m. Lunch for 12 booked at a chicken rice ball shop. The drive is about 3 hours each way. Home by midnight.